A-A-30174
April 30, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

INDICATOR, STERILIZATION
(Steam and Ethylene Oxide)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description describes chemical sterilization indicators designed for placement inside packages prepared for sterilization.

Salient characteristics Sterilization indicators shall be designed for placement inside packages containing items to be sterilized by use of steam or ethylene oxide (EtO), or steam and EtO sterilization cycles. Indicators shall be constructed of sensitized paper on a strip of single bar design, double bar design or diagonal bars design. A distinct and clear color change on the sensitized paper after sterilization shall be proof the item packaged with that indicator has been exposed to parameters necessary for steam or ethylene oxide sterilization, as appropriate.

Indicators shall be removed from the sterilized package and interpreted by the end user who must decide the item sterilized is safe for use. Aeration of EtO sterilized items and prolonged storage of steam and EtO sterilized items shall have no affect on the indicator.

Complete and detailed instructions for the use and interpretation of indicator results shall be provided with each unit.

Indicators covered by this document shall be of the following types.

Type 1 - For ethylene oxide (EtO) sterilization

Type 2 - For steam sterilization

Type 3 - For ethylene oxide (EtO) and steam sterilization

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design, color change of indicator, use, size, packaging and other features shall be of the following styles

Style A - Single bar design, for 250, 270 and 285 degrees F. (121, 132 and 140 degrees C.) steam cycles, color standard used to compare color change, 8 - 1/2 inches (215.90 mm) long, 1000/box, 4 boxes per case, 4000s.

Style B - Single bar design, for 250, 270 and 285 degrees F. (121, 132 and 140 degrees C.) steam cycles, color standard used to compare color change, 4 - 1/2 inches (114.30 mm) long, 250/box, 20 boxes per case, 5000s.

Style C - Single bar design, for 250 and 272 degrees F. (121 and 132 degrees C.) steam cycles, color change from white to black, 8 inches (203.20 mm) long, 250s.

Style D - Single bar design, for 250 and 270 degrees F. (121 and 132 degrees C.) steam cycles, color change from off-white to black, 250s

Style E - Double bar design, for 270 degrees F. (132 degrees C.) steam cycles, both bars change color from purple to green, 4 - 1/4 inches (107.95 mm) long, 200/box, 20 boxes per case, 4000s.

Style F - Diagonal bar design, for 250 and 270 degrees F. (121 and 132 degrees C.) steam cycles, color change from off-white to dark brown or black, in roll of 1 - 9/16 inches (39.687 mm) wide x 60 yards (54.80 m) long, 20 rolls per case.

Style G - Single bar design, for EtO cycles, color change from red to green, 8 inches (203.20 mm) long, 250/box, - boxes per case, 1000s

Style H - Single bar design, for EtO cycles, color change from yellow to deep blue, 200s.

Style I - Double bar design, for EtO cycles, left color bar changes to brown, right color bar changes to blue, 4 - 1/4 inches (107.95 mm) long, 200s

Style J - Diagonal bar design, for EtO cycles, color change from off-white to red, in roll of 1 - 9/16 inches (39.687 mm) x 60 yards (54.80 m)

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Style H - Single bar design, for EtO and 250 and 270 degrees F. (121 and 132 degrees C. steam cycles, color change to brown indicates steam sterilization parameters have been met, color change to orange indicates EtO sterilization parameters have been met, Long strip, 250s.

Style I - Single bar design, for EtO and 250 and 270 degrees F. (121 and 132 degrees C.) steam cycles, color change to brown indicates steam sterilization parameters have been met, color change to orange indicates EtO sterilization parameters have been met, Short strip, 250s

Workmarship. The sterilization indicators shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit Package (PG). One package containing the number of sterilization indicators specified in Style A through E, G through I, F and J above, constitutes one unit. Roll (RO) is the unit for Styles F and J. Unit shall be stated in the solicitation.

Quality Assurance Provisions

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract of purchase order, the contractor is resporsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the government. The government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with this commercial item description requirements Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one sterilization indicator as specified in this description.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product

Contractor certification The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract

Regulatory requirements

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the

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... Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order

NOTE. The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document

Type 1 - Style C - NSN 6530-01-345-4089

Type 1 - Style H - NSN 6530-01-210-1347

Type 1 - Style I - NSN 6530-01-325-9807

Type 1 - Style J - NSN 6530-01-345-2852

Type 2 - Style A - NSN 6530-01-345-2156

Type 2 - Style B - NSN 6530-01-345-2155

Type 2 - Style C - NSN 6530-01-213-9503

Type 2 - Style [illegible] - NSN 6530-01-210-1348

Type 2 - Style [illegible] - NSN 6530-01-[illegible]-4090

Type 2 - Style F - NSN 6530-01-171-7607

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Type 1 - Style A - NSN 6530-01-334-5868

Type 3 - Style L - NSN 6530-01-336-6149

Copies of Federal Standard No. 376, Preferred Metric Units for General Use by the Federal Government and MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20420.

Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description
(b) Type, style, packaging and unit.

MILITARY INTERESTS. CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES

Military Coordinating Activity: FDA-MPQAS
PHS

DoD-MB

PREPARING ACTIVITY

VA-OSS VAMKC (904)
Agent VA-OSS VACO (92A)

AGENT

DLA-DM

Custodians

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

Project No. 6530-2950

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